When turned, check the handles match

Trim the end grain as needed

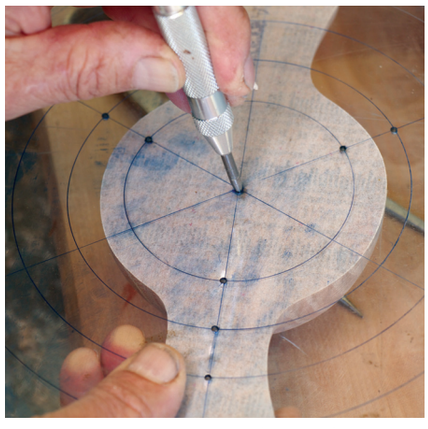
4 Check the length of the handles, and adjust as necessary. A ⅜-in. (10mm) fingernail-ground gouge is the safest tool to use across the end grain, being least likely to catch while cutting cleanly.

5 Shape matching handles. An advantage of laminating the blank is that you get a better idea of the thickness of each handle than when turning a solid blank.

6 Sand the spindle. Heavy sanding removed the slight bulge on the upper left of the sphere.

Finish shaping the handles using a gouge

Sand the form before splitting the blank. Finish is applied later



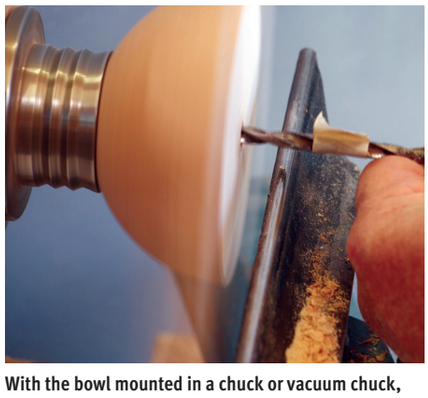
If you don't have a vacuum chuck (as I don't), use a template to find centre and mark for drilling a hole for a screw chuck

Mount the half bowl on a screw chuck and turn a small foot so you can remount the bowl for hollowing

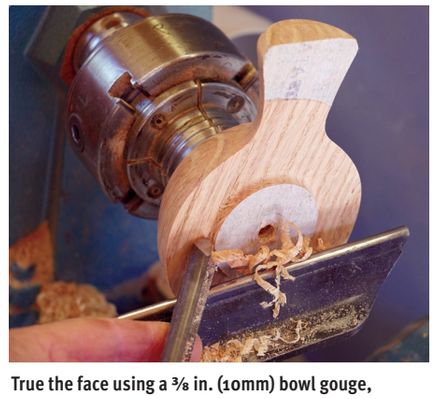
7 Split the spindle by tapping a chisel into the glueline at one end. A solid blank will need to be mounted in a carrier to be cut on a bandsaw. Never attempt to split a rounded form using any other sort of power saw. If you have a vacuum chuck, you can go straight to Step 9. The rest of us need to find the center of each half. You can do this by eye, scribing circles with dividers or a compass, but a center-finder makes life a lot easier. (You can make one by marking concentric circles on a sheet of clear plastic, drawing a line across the sheet through center, and drilling a small hole at center.) Align the centerline of the center-finder with the cones made by the lathe centers, then use a circle on the center-finder to locate the center on the blank and mark that.

8 Drill a hole at the center of the blank and mount the blank on a screw chuck so you can turn a small foot on the base. For me this is a temporary foot that enables me to grip the bowl for hollowing. I make it as small as I can get away with, but there is no reason why you shouldn't flatten the base and turn a more refined foot to retain on the finished piece, thereby cutting out Step 12.

9 Mount the blank for hollowing. Here I'm using 1⅜-in. (35mm) Vicmarc Shark Jaws to grip the 1/16-in.- (1.5mm-) high foot. Drill a depth hole so you'll end up with a base ¼ in. (6mm) thick. The handles whirring around are an obvious hazard, so position the rest before switching on the lathe and make sure you keep your fingers on the tailstock side of the rest.



With the bowl mounted in a chuck or vacuum chuck, drill a depth hole before hollowing



True the face using a ⅜ in. (10mm) bowl gouge, working in from about halfway up the handle

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